



CRY Foundation
Summer Internship Report

Submitted by

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I would like to express my heartfelt gratitude to Child Rights and You (CRY) for providing me with this incredible opportunity to intern under their finance team. I sincerely thank my supervisor and the entire team for their guidance, support, and patience throughout my six-week internship. I also extend my gratitude to my faculty and program coordinators at O.P. Jindal Global University for making this internship possible as a part of my academic learning.

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Introduction

My six-week internship at the Finance Department of Child Rights and You (CRY), a reputable and well-established Indian non-governmental organization committed to advancing and defending the rights of disadvantaged children, is described in this report. As a student in O.P. Jindal Global University's Integrated BBA + MBA program, the internship was a crucial component of my academic career and was designed to close the gap between classroom theory and real-world application. All things considered, the internship gave me a well-rounded experience that strengthened my academic knowledge and deepened my understanding of how professional abilities may be applied to further social development objectives.

About the Organization

Child Rights and You (CRY) is a leading Indian non-governmental organization established in 1979 by Rippan Kaur, dedicated to ensuring the rights of underprivileged children across India. CRY believes that every child is entitled to a happy childhood, and it works towards securing children's rights to education, health, protection, and participation.

CRY works to protect and uphold children's rights, focusing on education, healthcare, and freedom from violence and exploitation. It partners with local NGOs across India to implement its programs and advocates for systemic change to benefit children.

In India, CRY has worked with more than 3 million children. In 19 states, they have collaborated with 102 regional NGOs. CRY has been instrumental in promoting laws such as the Right to Education Act. In addition, they have worked directly with the local communities and NGOs to increase vaccination rates, save children from abusive conditions, and advance education.

Roles and Responsibilities

During my internship with the **Finance Department at CRY**, I was introduced to the foundational processes involved in managing NGO finances. A key part of my role involved learning about expense vouchers—their formats, supporting documents, and importance in financial reporting and compliance. I assisted in tagging expense vouchers to their respective documents and accounts, ensuring they were organized and appropriately classified for internal tracking and audit purposes. This helped me understand how expenses are mapped to specific programs and cost centers, maintaining clarity in fund utilization. I also became familiar with CRY's Financial Management System (FMS) portal, where I observed how entries are listed and how financial data is stored digitally for real-time tracking and reporting. Additionally, I developed a working knowledge of relevant financial regulations such as FCRA (Foreign Contribution Regulation Act), FEMA, TDS, and Income Tax norms that are critical for NGO compliance. These tasks helped me build a strong foundation in nonprofit finance, linking classroom theories to the real-world responsibilities of financial documentation, transparency, and donor accountability.

Field Experience

Along with my office-based duties, CRY and JKG International School collaborated to create an insightful field trip that I was able to take part in. We held interactive workshops aimed at introducing disadvantaged children to digital learning as part of this outreach program. Reducing the digital divide, which frequently restricts access to high-quality education, and increasing their acquaintance with fundamental technologies were the main goals.

In these classes, we introduced students to the basic pieces of a computer, including the keyboard, mouse, CPU, and monitor, and helped them learn how these parts work together. Additionally, we led them through basic computer programs, such as Microsoft Paint, which sparked their interest and involvement by enabling them to experiment with digital coloring and painting.

I was able to observe firsthand how CRY's programs actually help children at the local level thanks to this practical experience. It also helped me better grasp how crucial efficient planning, budgeting, and financial resource allocation are to setting up and maintaining such worthwhile fieldwork.

Key Learnings

I gained insightful knowledge from my internship with CRY that helped me connect theoretical ideas with real-world applications in the charity industry. Understanding the legal and financial compliance structures unique to non-governmental organizations was one of the most important learning objectives. I learned about important laws like the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) and the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA), which regulate how businesses handle and disclose foreign contributions. Additionally, I learnt about income tax and TDS (tax deductible at source) regulations and how they specifically affect non-governmental organizations and incomes.

The handling of vouchers and financial documents was another important subject of study. I was given instructions on how vouchers are made, examined, and filed even though I didn't process them personally. In order to better understand how each financial transaction is connected to project outcomes and audit trails, I helped attach vouchers to the relevant papers and program heads.

I also learned about CRY's Financial Management System (FMS) portal, which is a digital tool for handling financial information. I became more aware of the significance of digitization and data accuracy in charity operations after seeing how the portal is used to record, retrieve, and organize financial data.

Understanding how closely finance and program delivery are intertwined may have been the most influential lesson learned. I witnessed how CRY's field operations, training initiatives, and community outreach are made possible by the thoughtful distribution of money. Whether it's a child's school equipment, an awareness lesson, or access to technology, every voucher, budget line, and report links back to a tangible result. It reaffirmed the notion that every rupee measured and purposefully spent results in significant, observable change.

Skills Developed

This internship played a significant role in helping me build a strong foundation in both technical and interpersonal skills, which are essential for a career in finance and the development sector.

Technically speaking, I became more familiar with financial documentation and analysis, especially from working with expenditure vouchers and comprehending how they relate to project budgets. I became more aware of the ways that thorough financial documentation supports fund accountability, audit readiness, and organizational transparency. I also gained an understanding of the fundamentals of dealing with regulatory frameworks like the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) and the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA), which are essential for guaranteeing legal compliance in NGOs that receive both foreign and domestic financing.

I also had the chance to see how the Financial Management System (FMS) Portal, an ERP-like system, was utilized, introducing me to the digital infrastructure that charitable organizations use to manage massive amounts of financial data. My understanding of how technology enhances financial operational efficiency has grown as a result of this.

My development of soft skills was equally significant. My ability to collaborate and communicate was improved by working in a professional setting, where I interacted with team members, provided clarification on tasks, and routinely requested feedback. As I worked on organizing documents and following established procedures, I also became more accountable and better at managing my time. I received a deep feeling of social empathy and an understanding of how money contributes to grassroots community and child empowerment through my involvement in field activities.

These abilities, which I acquired via practical experience, have not only enhanced my academic knowledge but also influenced my own perspective on meaningful and accountable employment.

(i) Field Trip at JKG school



(ii) With the mentors and finance team



Conclusion

My experience working as an intern for Child Rights and You (CRY) has been immensely fulfilling, enlightening, and life-changing. It gave me the opportunity to go beyond what I learned in the classroom and get hands-on experience with the operational and financial facets of a nationally renowned non-governmental organization. I gained a real grasp of how regulatory compliance, clear paperwork, and efficient financial planning serve as the cornerstones of successful social impact work by fully immersing myself in CRY's finance department.

This internship broadened my understanding of social justice, child rights, and the value of inclusive education in addition to improving my understanding of finance in the development sector. I was able to observe how even administrative positions have a noticeable, long-lasting effect on the ground by participating in both frontline outreach initiatives and backend finance processes. I realized that every budget line, policy, and process—whether it's providing educational resources to kids or launching campaigns to raise awareness of digital issues—contributes to tangible change.

My long-term goal to work in a field that combines social responsibility and financial discipline has also been strengthened by the experience. I am now more comfortable negotiating the nexus of strategic planning, regulation, and development. I am still deeply appreciative of CRY's guidance and assistance, as well as O.P. Jindal Global University's promotion of experiential learning experiences that genuinely equip students for fulfilling employment.

